

also help. Finding patterns becomes easier when data sets grow bigger. Sure it takes more time to parse a larger database, but it also makes the accuracy of predictions better. This would help get to cures for what's currently incurable, and improve healing times because we will have more data to support what really is the best method, to say, heal a broken collarbone (in the long run). There will also be the advantage

of having data from all over the world shared, so perhaps all that data will help us identify specific genes that put us at more risk for some diseases, or even make us more accepting of certain medicines to get cured...

Humongous data for medicine, really does have the capability to significantly reduce suffering in the world. It would also bring down the cost of medicines, and reduce the burden on insurance.

Apart from just big data and networking, a mix of sensor technologies, wearable tech and standard communication protocols will mean that if you ever collapse on a road, the first paramedic who reaches you in the ambulance (or for India, when you are wheeled into the emergency room of a hospital) your entire medical history can be downloaded from a wristband that you're wearing, or maybe from your smartphone, or smartwatch.

HUMANISED TECH

Disrupter: Digital assistants, personalised tech

Disrupted: Apps, services

What Year: 2018 to 2020

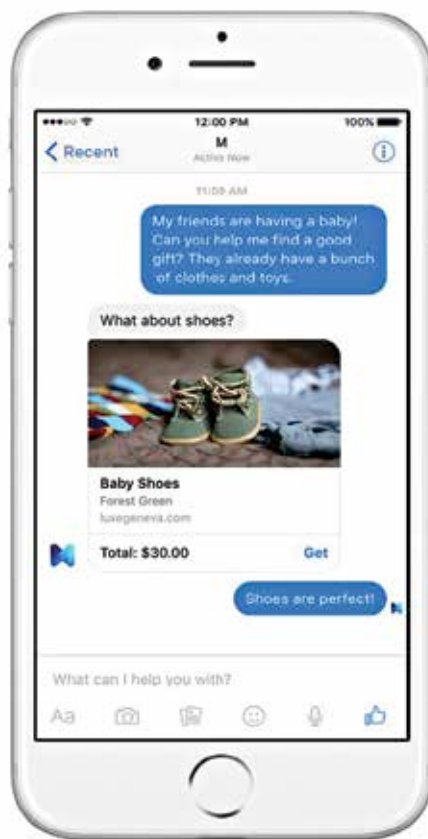
This is probably what we see happening the soonest.

If the internet brought the world to our doorstep, then social media and smartphones made things more localised and familiar (you make friends more from the same city, or those who have similar interests, have the same friends... like a college clique). For the future, we're predicting that tech will have to make things hyper-local, and be focussed on you, and you alone.

You can already see from digital assistants that every big company is putting out there that people feel the money lies in making the technology seem more personal. You are now so special, and people want your business so much, that they're designing their technologies to appear tailor-made for you.

It's all mind-games, and the psychological warfare is being kicked into top gear now. We've written in the past about how you are walking money, and the more unique users a site or service can boast of, and the more information they have about those unique users, the more said site or service is valued in the market. This is the one thing that will never change. Unless rats can figure out how to make money and buy stuff (the creativity and persistence of our office rats sometimes make us think this could actually be possible), humans are going to be the real currency of the future.

The next step in technology is to make your phone unique to you, or your



Facebook's new personal assistant, M

interface with technology unique to you. Netflix (for those who've used it) makes different profiles for different people in the house, based on the movies each one of you watch, your gender, age, etc. The movies it suggests get more relevant over time. It 'learns'. So does Facebook, and YouTube, and every other service. So why

does Siri talk to every iPhone user the same way? What about Cortana? Facebook has started experimenting with M, a chat agent in Messenger that you can talk to and ask questions, and even get it to buy you things (using your money of course).

The idea's not new, to be honest. Services such as Magic (US only), allow you to chat with a person who acts like an assistant and gets things done. Let's say you are busy at work, it's your mum's birthday, and even though you will be late to see her (or maybe she's in a different city), you can chat with someone, ask them for suggestions on what you can buy your mum, ask them about your options for flowers, and they will provide you all the information that you could have found yourself, eventually. They take a small "tip" for their services when you transact with them, but really, they just do what you could have with smart Googling skills and half an hour of focus. A great service for those who don't have that half an hour to spare, and prefer the chat interface.

However, it's not just assistants, we see apps, phone OSes, and everything learning from your behaviour, and adapting to be more relevant to you. Your entire interface with technology might just end up being like your Facebook timeline – finely tuned to getting you to "just keep scrolling, just keep scrolling" – say that out loud in your best Dory imitation (the blue forgetful fish in Finding Nemo, voiced by Ellen DeGeneres).